

– Creative Block –

Code Convention

Team 25

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General

Add all new code to a new branch rather than the main branch. Docs and artifacts can be added to the main branch. Merges will be done by Ori.

All class/variable/function names should describe what they relate to or are used for.

Keep the Next.js server running while edits are made to the code to view changes in real time and catch errors

Frontend [Next.js]

HTML Formatting

- HTML page must include explicit start and end `<type></type>` for every element
- Special CSS formats should be identified by for ex. `<h1 id = "Title">`
- Instead of standard 'class' identification, use 'className' in Next.js
- The layout.tsx must hold a link to the format code which is in its own file

- `<html>` tags are not included in the page.tsx file
- Use HTML naming convention such as: `<ul>` `<img>` `<li>` `<div>` `<a href>` `<p>`
- Start variables and functions with a lowercase letter and use the format of `nameConventionText()`
- Start classes with an uppercase letter and use the format of `ClassName`
- Indent new divisions as reasonable to keep code legible
- Avoid line lengths over 80 characters

CSS Formatting

- Use Verdana as the main font type
- Explicitly identify text color/size/weight for each text box
- Import CSS format file using 'import "relative/filepath"', not '`<link rel="stylesheet" href="styles.css">`'
- Use `.ExampleClassName` to apply formatting to child formats
- Use `#ExampleClassName` to apply formatting to only that object
- Align elements to the outside of the screen, not other elements
- Break formats into sub formats where possible to keep formatting clear
- Only use the color codes from the color palette for background field elements

Next.js Specific Formatting

- Place each new page in a new folder, where the folder name is the intended name of the page to display
- Each page is named page.tsx, the associated formatting is in layout.tsx in the same folder

- Use the layout.tsx file to format the page
- Read documentation for Next.js before adding new features

Backend [Python]

CSV Formatting

- Use a separate csv file for each database
- Use the csv or pandas libraries to edit the user database
- Always order the file consistently, in a reasonable order [i.e. | username | password | email | ...]
- Make sure each column has a clear header that identifies what the column contains

Python Formatting

- Import all necessary libraries at the beginning of the file
- Start variables and function names with a lowercase letter and use the format of nameConventionText()
- Test Python code by adding print statements and frequently checking individual functions
- Add comments where possible to describe what the code is doing
- Limit the code under the main() function, have the main() function call other functions that implement the code
- Separate each function by at least one empty line

Middleware [Next.js]

Next.js Specific Information

- Pull from the main branch before changing any code to ensure the system is up to date
- Place header information in a separate component file if display issues occur, otherwise place in a <div> along with the body
- Place each page.tsx in a unique folder and link to the file location using relative paths
- User specific pages should be in dynamic folders for example 'app/blog/[folder]/page.tsx' where [folder] is a parameter in page
- Private folders should be named _folder
- Build new pages directly in Next.js while the server is running to see changes immediately
- Label folders as the intended display path on the server
- Shut down the server before turning off the computer to prevent broken port usage
- Place all new page locations inside of the app folder
- Place all HTML to display in a way that it may be displayed as is when returned by the display function

Other

Additional Software

- Auth.js for authentication
- Postgres server for user database
- JSON scripts for dynamic pages
- Excel sheets for data in dynamic pages
- React for React Javascript elements

GitHub Convention

- New branches are named to be clear what has been worked on
- General information and non-code documents are added to the artifacts
- Copies of pages can be added to the artifacts folder to protect them from accidental overwrites
- Merge errors are discussed with the person whose branch is causing a merge conflict before resolution
- Frequent commits are made to a branch before merging